MINISTRY OF FORESTS

Harvest Billing System

User Manual

November 10, 2026

Revision 9ce944e

For ministry (IDIR) and industry (Business BCeID) users

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About this manual

This manual is for the people who use HBS day to day: ministry staff (IDIR) and industry users such as licensees, scale sites, submission agents and scale-software vendors (Business BCeID). It describes what you see on screen and how to get a job done.

How to read this manual

- **Menu paths** are written as **Area › Menu item**, for example **Scale Returns › Summary Returns**. The areas are the groups in the left-hand menu.
- **You only see what your roles allow.** If a menu item, button or area in this manual is missing for you, you don't hold a role that grants it. See Who can do what, then ask your HBS administrator.
- **Industry users only ever see their own organization's data.** Where a search has a client number field, the system applies your active organization whatever you type.

1. Getting started

Logging in

HBS uses BC Government single sign-on.

You are	Log in with
Ministry staff	**IDIR** (with multi-factor authentication)
Licensee, scale site, submission agent or software vendor	**Business BCeID**

Your access comes from the roles granted to you in FAM (Forest Access Management). If you can log in but HBS says you are not authorized, you have no HBS role yet. See How to get access.

Choosing an organization (industry users)

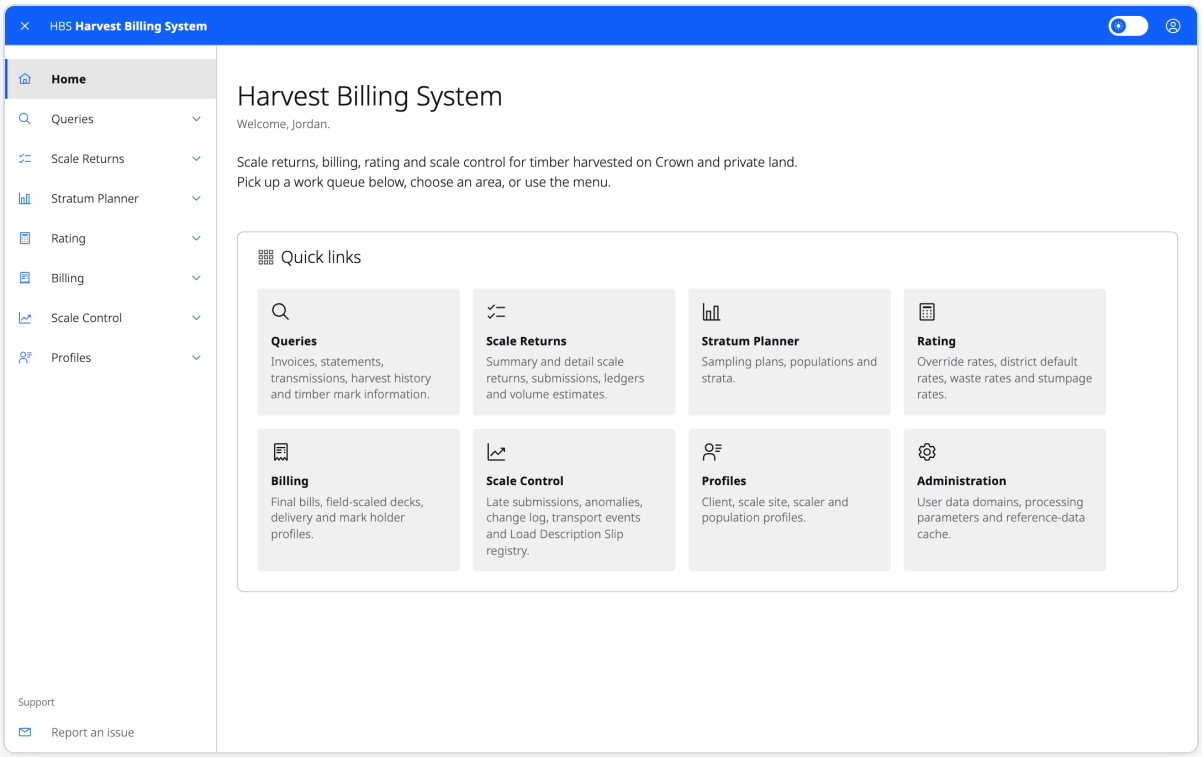
If your Business BCeID is registered with more than one forest-client organization, HBS asks you to **Select organization** after you log in. Your roles can differ for each organization, and everything you see and do applies to the organization you chose. To work for a different organization, log out and log in again.

Ministry users don't choose an organization.

The home page

The home page welcomes you and shows:

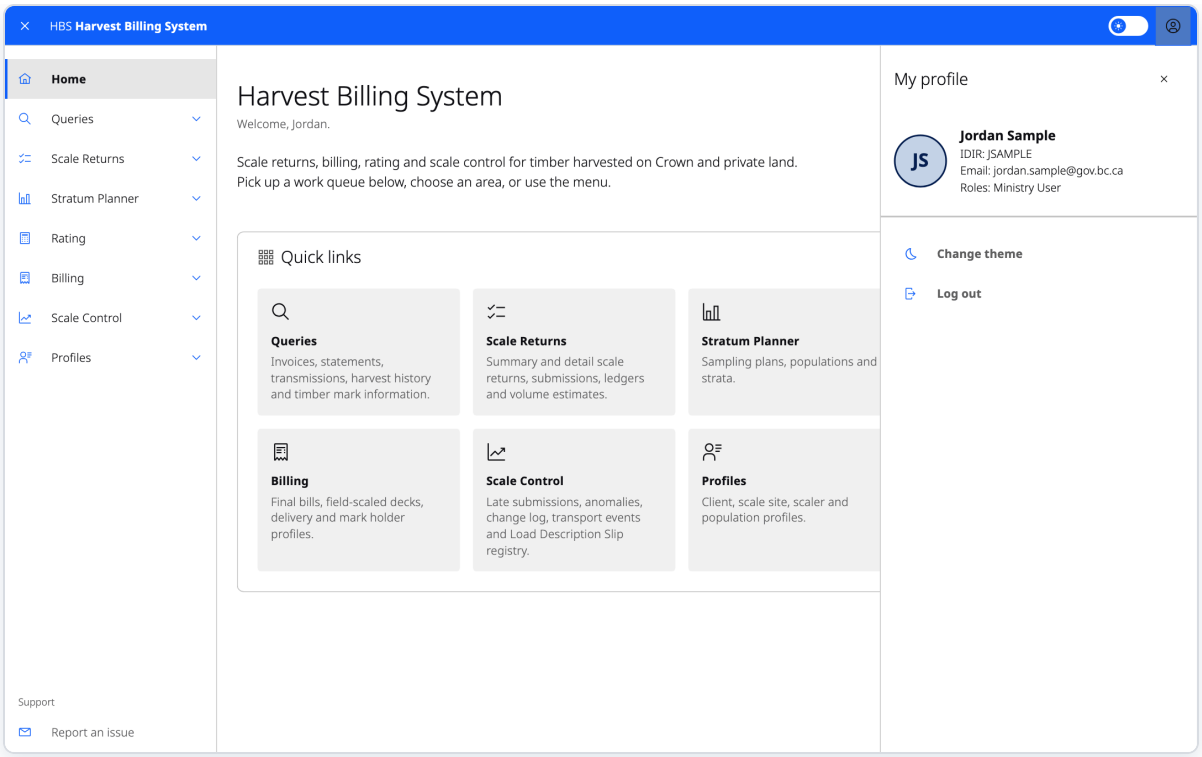
- **Notice** — the current HBS alert message, such as a planned outage. It only appears when there is one.
- **Work queues** — links to the summary and detail scale returns that need attention, grouped by status (for example *In Progress*, *Awaiting Approval*, *In Error*, *Rejected*). Select a link to open the matching list of returns. Only shown for roles that have queues to work.
- **Quick links** — one tile for each area you can use.



The home page with the menu open

Your profile

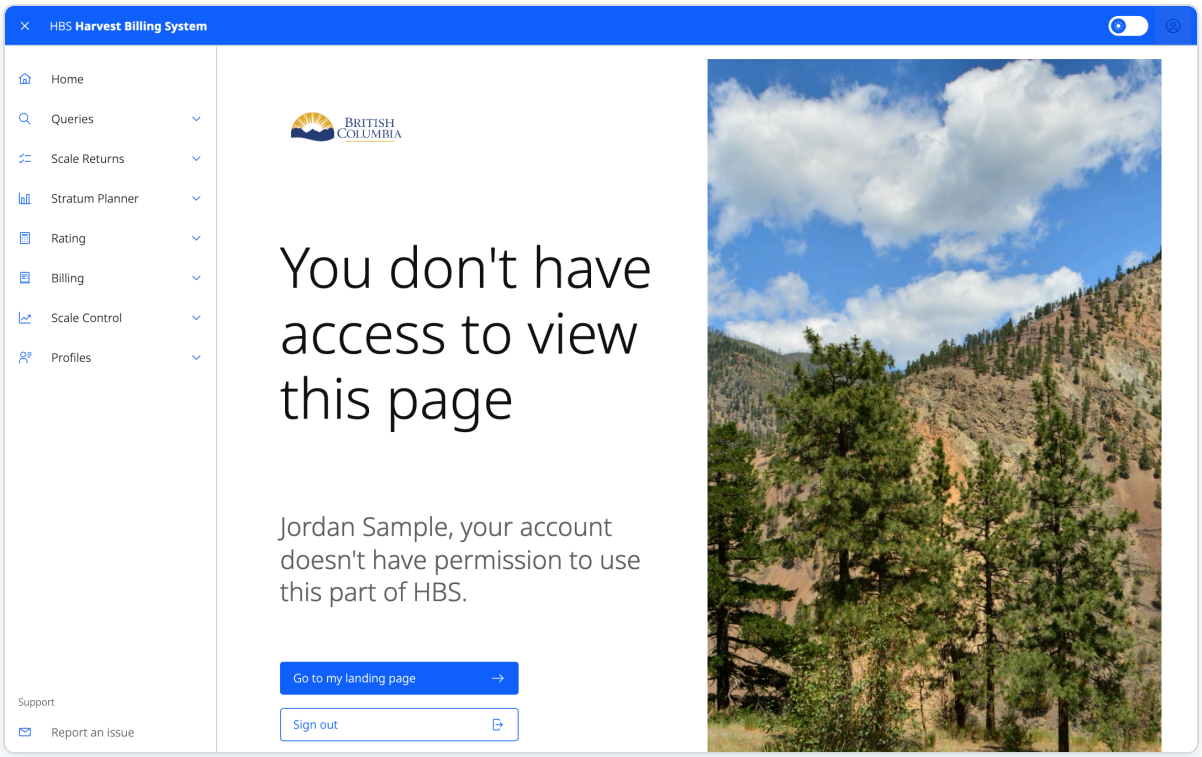
Select your profile picture in the header to see your user ID, your active organization (industry users) and the roles you hold. From there you can also **Change theme** (light or dark) and **Log out**.



The profile panel

Finding your way around

The left-hand menu groups screens into areas, in the same order as the legacy tab bar: **Queries**, **Scale Returns**, **Stratum Planner**, **Rating**, **Billing**, **Scale Control**, **Profiles** and **Administration**. An area only appears if you can use at least one screen in it. If you open a link to a screen your roles don't allow, HBS says so and offers to take you back to your landing page.



The page shown when your roles don't allow a screen

Labels in the menu are shorter than the screen titles: for example, the menu item **Summary Returns** opens **Search for Summary Scale Returns**.

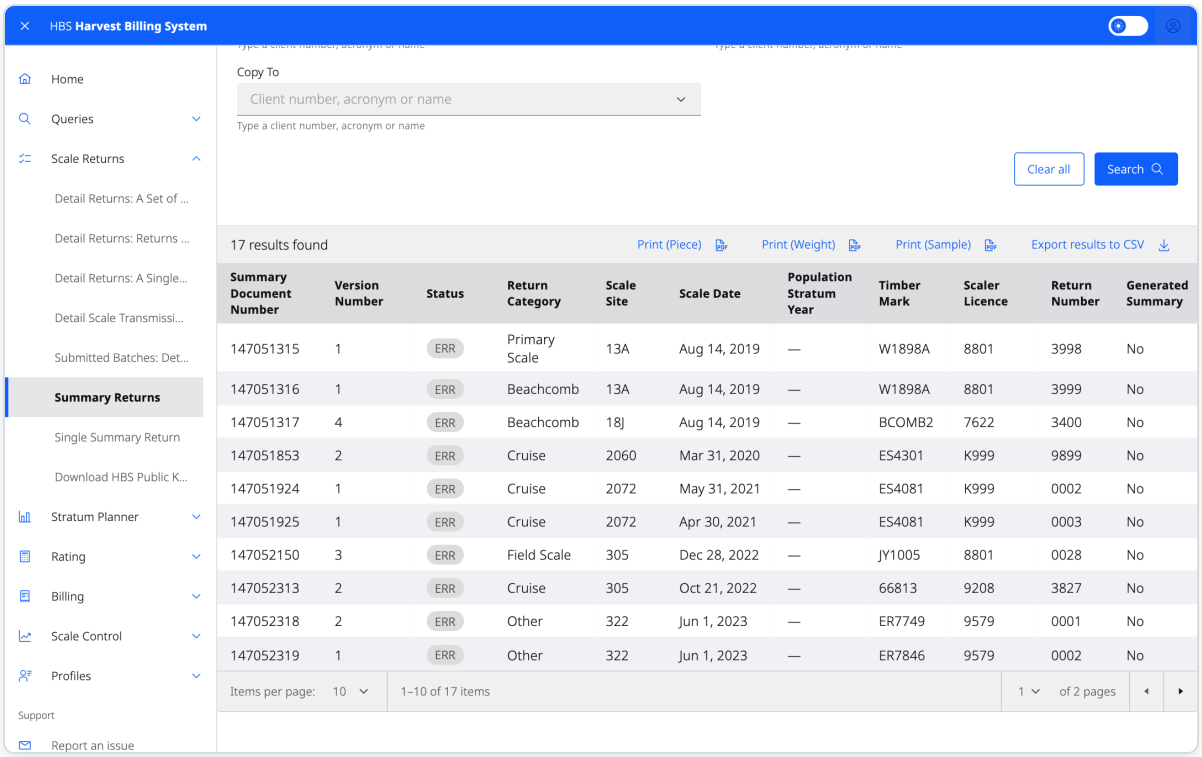
Select the menu icon (top left) to hide or show the menu. **Report an issue**, at the bottom of the menu, emails the HBS support team.

Many screens are not in the menu. You reach them from a search result, for example by selecting a document number to open the return.

Searching

Most screens are searches. They all work the same way:

1. Fill in the **criteria** at the top. Fields marked with `*` are required. Some searches ask for "at least one of" a set of fields; the description under the title says which.
2. Select **Search**. Results appear in the grey panel below with a count.
3. Select a column heading to sort, where the column allows it. Use the pager at the bottom to move between pages or change the page size.
4. Select a highlighted value (such as a document number) to open that record.
5. **Clear all** empties the criteria and the results.
6. **Export results to CSV** downloads every result row as a spreadsheet file.



A search screen: criteria, the results count with print and export buttons, the results table and the pager

HBS remembers your last search on each screen for the rest of your browser session, so going back to a search screen shows the same results.

Timber marks, licences and codes are converted to upper case as you type.

Printing and downloading

Buttons such as **Print**, **Download PDF** or **Download CSV** run a report from your current criteria or the record you are viewing, and download the file. Some screens have a single **Print** menu with several reports; some open a small dialog asking for report options first.

Making changes

Buttons that change data (for example **Release**, **Hold**, **Approve**, **Delete**) appear only when your roles allow the action **and** the record is in a state where it makes sense. If a button you expect is missing, check the record's status first.

Actions that can't be undone ask you to confirm. Some show a preview of what will happen, for example which versions and transactions a cancel-and-replace creates, before you confirm.

On lists you can tick several rows and use a bulk action such as **Hold Selected**. HBS reports the result for each row: processed, not processed, or error.

Session time-out

After **30 minutes** without activity you are logged out. A warning with a countdown appears **5 minutes** before that. Select **Stay logged in** to continue. Unsaved changes on a form are lost when you are logged out.

Logging out

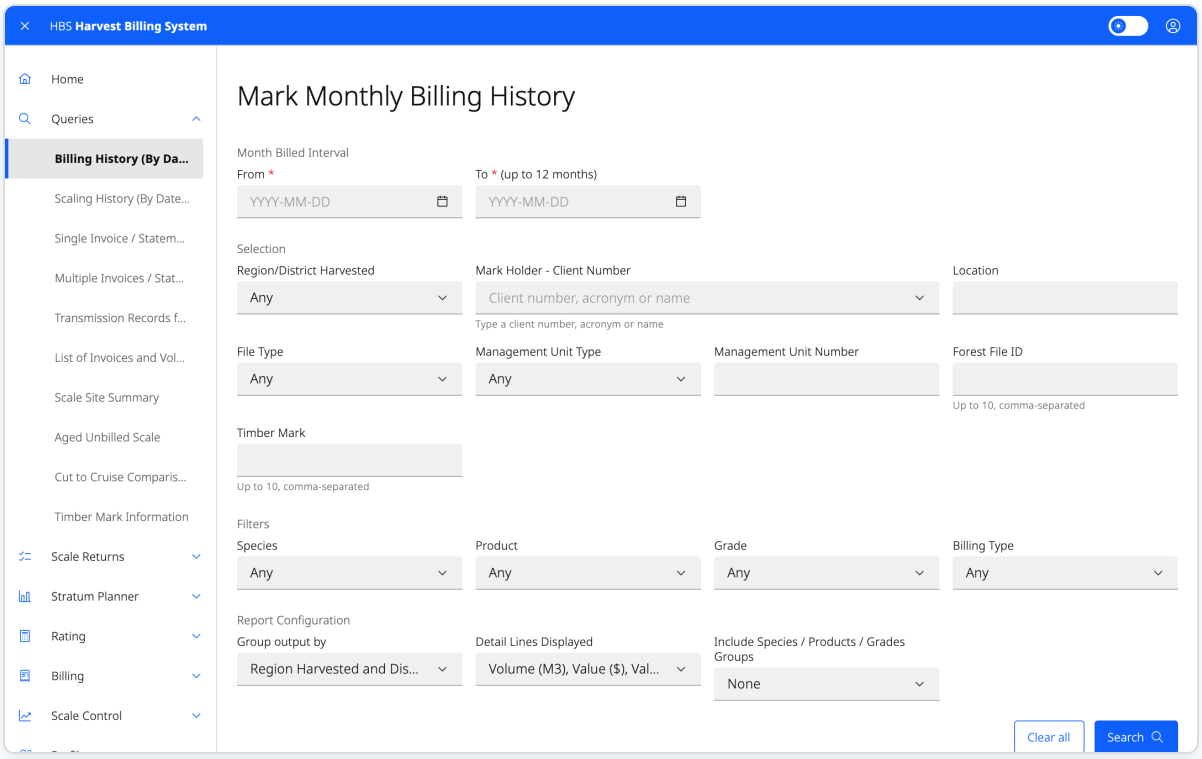
Select your profile picture in the header, then **Log out**. This ends your single sign-on session for HBS.

2. Queries

Look up invoices, statements, transmissions, harvest history and timber mark information. Available to ministry and forest-industry users. Industry users only see documents and history for their own organization.

Screens

Menu item	Use it to
Billing History (By Date of Invoice)	Report billed volumes and values by month for a date range, filtered by district, mark holder, management unit, forest file, timber mark, species, product, grade or billing type. Download as **PDF** or **CSV**.
Scaling History (By Date of Scale)	The same, for scaled volumes, with region/district scaled and scale site filters. Download as **PDF**.
Single Invoice / Statement	Open one invoice or statement by its statement number.
Multiple Invoices / Statements	Find invoices and statements by document type, number, scale or issue dates, timber mark, scale site, population, stratum, district or client (original, copy-to or both). Print the list or a client register.
Transmission Records for Invoices and Statements	See which statements were transmitted to a client, and when, between two dates.
List of Invoices and Volume Statements	Run the piece-scale or weight-scale billing summary report. You must give at least one of region/district of harvest, file type, management unit type, forest file ID or timber mark, **and** either region/district of scale or scale site.
Scale Site Summary	Summarize returns for scale sites or marks, grouped as you choose.
Aged Unbilled Scale	*Ministry only.* Find scale that has not been billed, by scale method, scaled before a date.
Cut to Cruise Comparison	Compare cut volumes with cruise volumes. Give a timber mark, forest file ID, client, or client and location.
Timber Mark Information	Look up a timber mark and open its details.



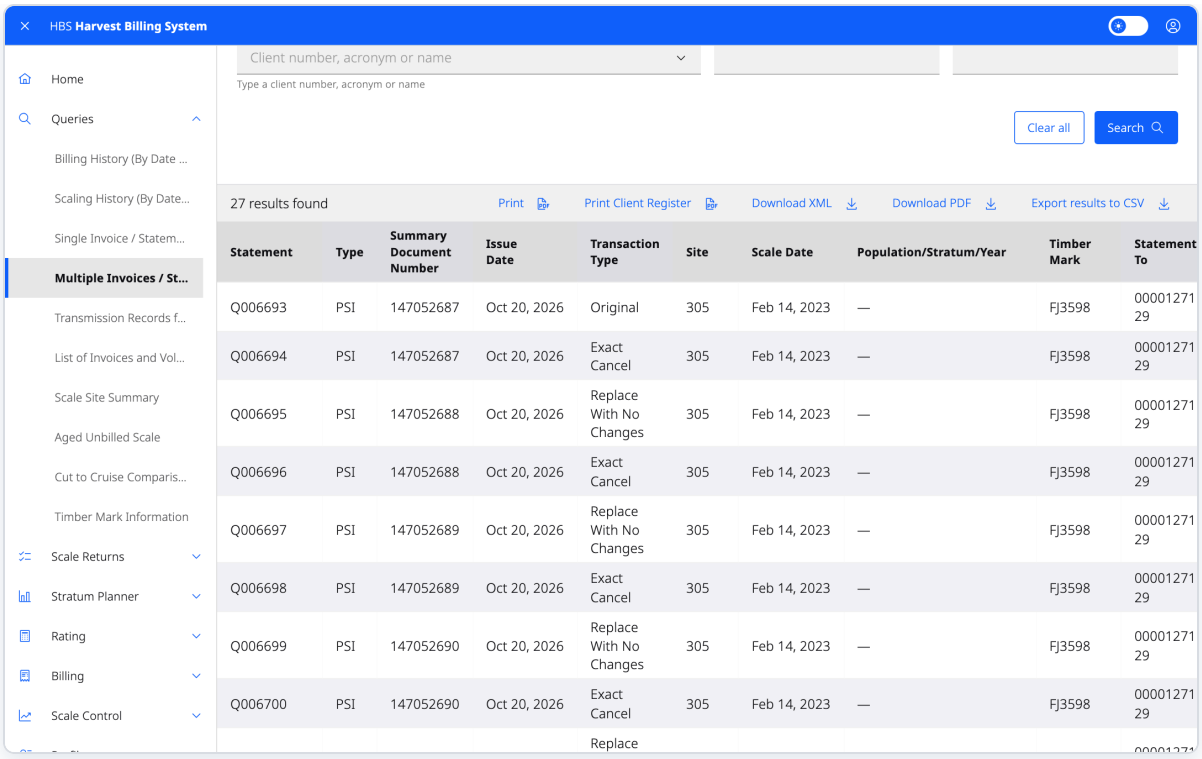
Billing History (By Date of Invoice) criteria

Common tasks

Get a copy of an invoice or statement

1. **Queries › Single Invoice / Statement**.
2. Enter the **Statement Number** and select **Search**.
3. Use the download button in the result row to save the PDF.

If you don't know the number, use **Multiple Invoices / Statements** with a timber mark and date range instead. Each result row has **PDF** and **XML** buttons under **Actions**.



Multiple Invoices / Statements: documents issued in the last 30 days

Check that statements reached a client

1. **Queries › Transmission Records for Invoices and Statements**.
2. Enter the client number, and a location if needed, and the date range.
3. Select **Search**.

Users with the Document Receiver role can also choose **Associated Locations** to cover every client location in their data domain.

3. Scale Returns

Enter, submit, review and correct scale returns. There are two kinds:

- **Summary scale returns** — one return summarizing scale for a mark and period: piece scale, weight scale or sample scale. Also used for cruise-based (area) billing and volume estimates.
- **Detail scale returns** — individual log tallies, weigh slips, sample tallies and arrival/departure ledgers, usually submitted as XML files by scale software.

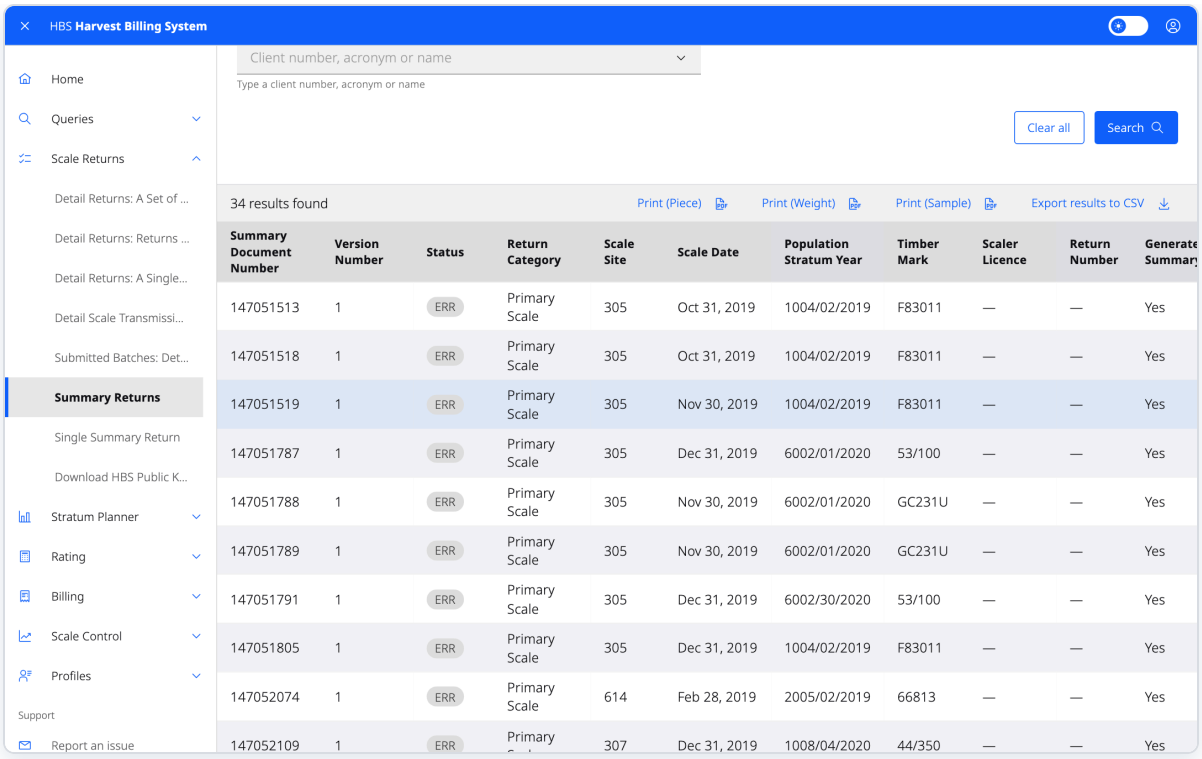
Everyone with an HBS role can view returns for their own data. Entering and changing returns needs one of the data entry, scaling or correction roles (see Who can do what).

Screens

Summary returns

Menu item	Use it to
Summary Returns	Find summary returns by scale type, document control number, version status, error code, dates, site, mark, scaler licence, return number or field deck. Select the document control number to open a return.
Single Summary Return	Open one return by summary document number or statement number.
Add Summary Return: Piece / Estimates	Enter a new piece-scale return. Also used for cruise-based billing (return type *AREAEST*) and volume estimate returns (cruise, field, waste, other).
Add Summary Return: Weight	Enter a new weight-scale return.
Add Summary Return: Sample	Enter a new sample-scale return.

A new summary return starts as state **Original In Progress**, version 1, status **Incomplete**.



Summary Returns: weight-scale returns in error

Detail returns

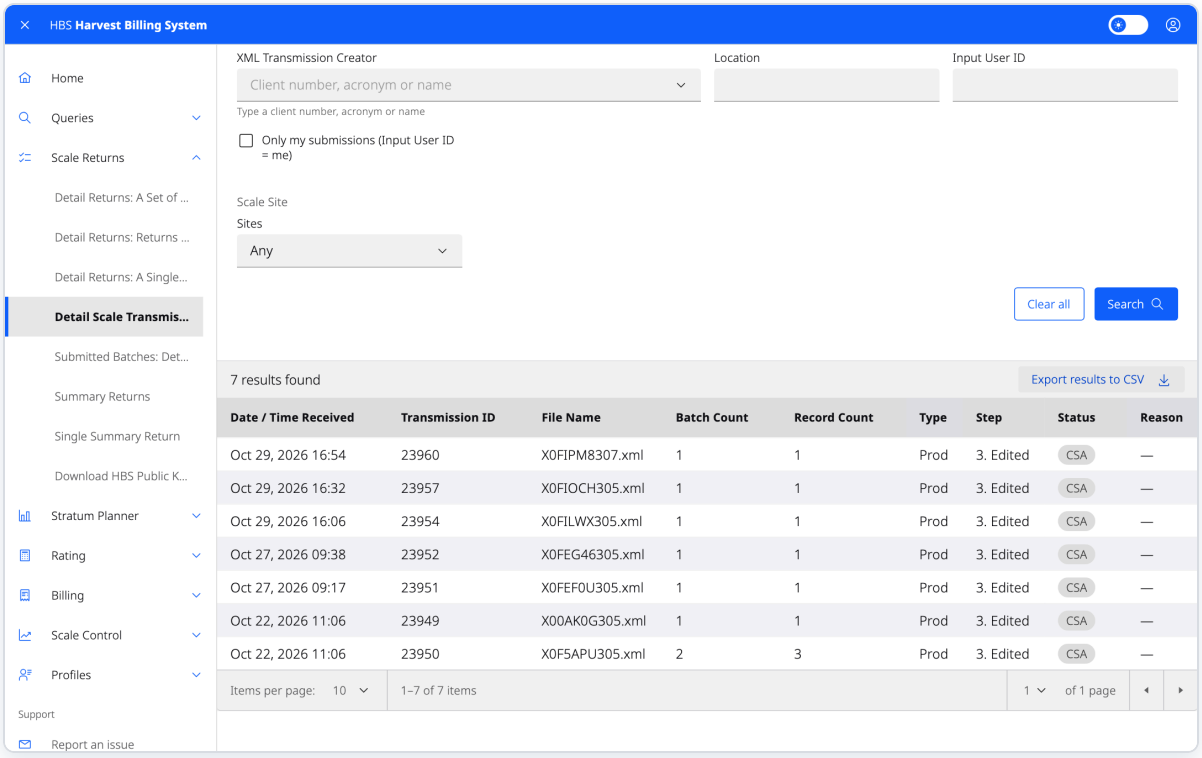
Menu item	Use it to
Detail Returns: A Set of Returns	Find detail returns by type, version status, event type, error code, dates, site, data domain, population/stratum, mark, cut block or scaler. Print lists or generate PDFs.
Detail Returns: Returns in Submitted Batches	Find returns by the batch they arrived in.
Detail Returns: A Single Return	Open one return by detail document number, or by site plus weigh slip, return type, scaler licence and return number.
Detail Scale Transmissions: XML	See XML files received, their processing step and status.
Submitted Batches: Detail	See the batches created from each transmission, and download a list of rejected documents.
Submit File of Detail Returns	Upload an XML file of detail returns.
Download HBS Public Key	Download the key scale software uses to encrypt submissions.

Common tasks

Submit a file of detail returns

1. **Scale Returns › Submit File of Detail Returns**.
2. Select **Find File** and choose the XML file. It must follow the HBS scale data schema (`HBS_Schema_V6_1b`).
3. Submit it.

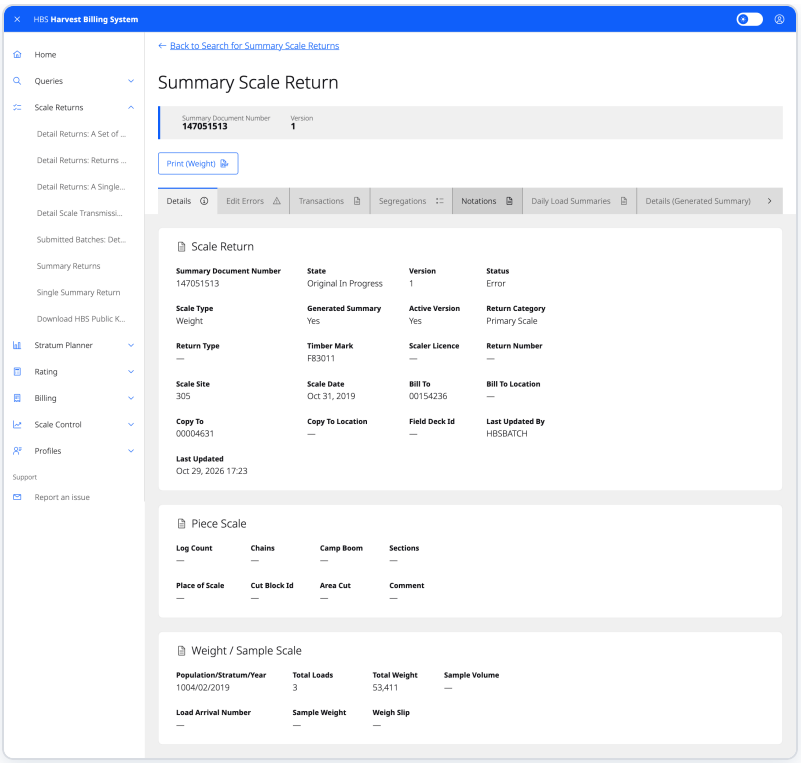
The file is virus-scanned and checked against the schema before it is accepted. If it fails validation, the errors are listed on screen and nothing is loaded. Once accepted, follow its progress in **Detail Scale Transmissions: XML**. Tick **Only my submissions** to see just yours.



Detail Scale Transmissions: XML

Work through a summary return

Open the return from **Summary Returns**. The tabs show the return's **Details**, **Edit Errors**, **Transactions**, **Segregations**, **Notations** and, for weight scale, **Daily Load Summaries**.



A summary scale return (viewed with a view-only role, so no action buttons show)

The buttons you see depend on your roles and the return's state:

Button	What it does
Update (edit)	Change an in-progress return. Generated summaries can never be edited.
Release	Release the return for billing.
Hold	Stop the return from being billed until it is released.
Discard	Throw away an in-progress version.
Cancel	Cancel an invoiced return.
Cancel & Replace With / Without Changes	Cancel an invoiced return and create a replacement version, edited or as-is.
Replace With / Without Changes	Replace a return that has been cancelled and invoiced.
Request Rate Correction	Ask for a rate correction on an invoiced generated summary.
Approve / Reject Rate Correction	Decide on a requested rate correction.

Before a cancel or replace, HBS shows a preview of the versions and transactions it will create. Confirm to go ahead.

Work through a detail return

Open the return from any detail search. Depending on your roles and its state you can **Release**, **Re-Edit**, **Hold**, **Cancel**, **Cancel and Replace with Changes**, **Replace with / without Changes**, **Discard** or **Clear Digital Signature Failure**. Changes that need sign-off show **Approve Change** and **Reject Change** to approvers. Use the **Print** buttons for a log tally, weigh slip, sample tally, special forest product tally or ledger entry.

Batch slips (ministry)

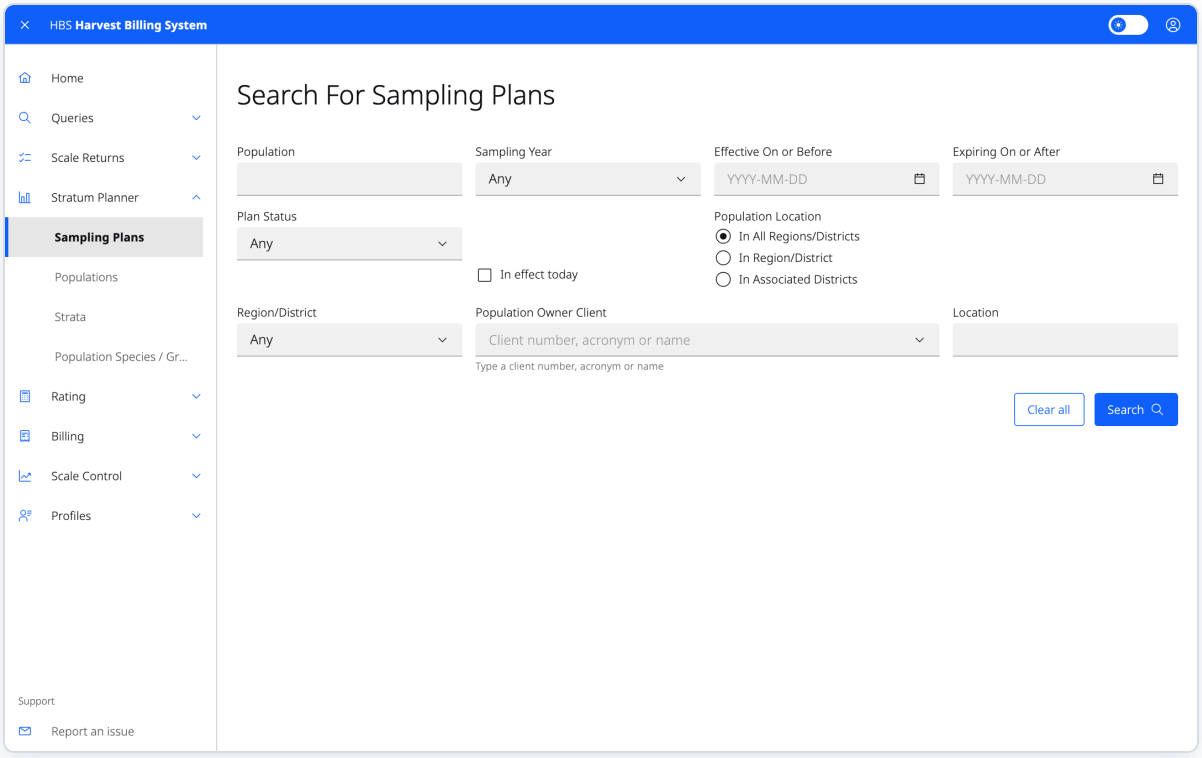
Batch slips track paper returns sent to headquarters. From a batch slip search you can **Generate a Batch Slip**, update one, and **Confirm** or **Cancel** it.

4. Stratum Planner

Manage weight-scale sampling: sampling plans, populations, strata and the default species/grade ratios used to convert weight to volume. Available to ministry and forest-industry users. Changes need the Sample Plan Administrator role (ministry, or industry for your own populations).

Screens

Menu item	Use it to
Sampling Plans	Find plans by population, sampling year, dates, status, location, district or owner.
Add Sampling Plan	Create a new plan. You can also create the population if it doesn't exist yet.
Populations	Find populations by population, year or owner.
Strata	List the strata in a population and year.
Population Species / Grades	Statistics for a population. Drill down to a stratum and to a single sample.



Search For Sampling Plans

Common tasks

Take a sampling plan through approval

1. Open the plan from **Sampling Plans**.
2. Add strata with **Add Stratum**. Open a stratum to edit it, set its **Estimates**, and add default ratios with **Add Default Ratio**.
3. Select **Propose** when the plan is ready.
4. An administrator selects **Approve** or **Reject**.

Other plan actions:

- **Copy** starts a new plan from this one.
- **Create New Plan From Actuals** starts one from the samples actually taken.
- **Delete** removes the plan.

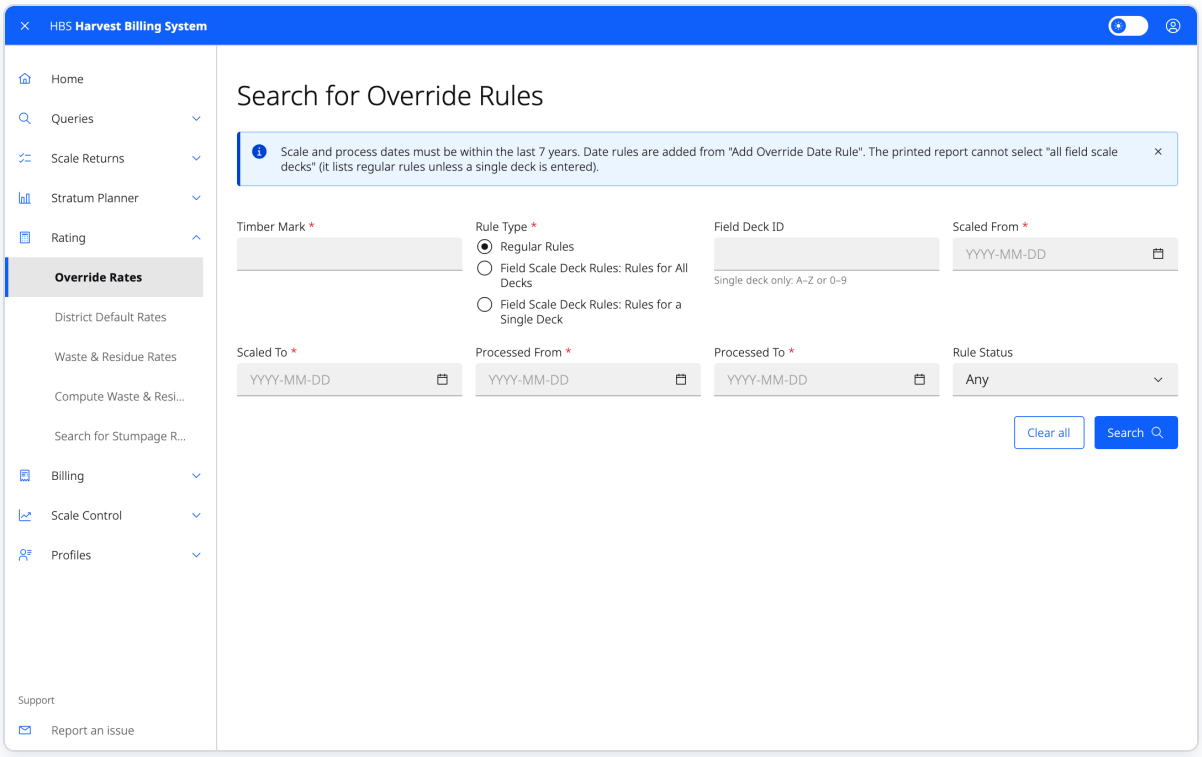
Use **Print Sample Plan Report** or **Print Stratum Description Report** for paper copies.

5. Rating

Look up and maintain the rates HBS bills with. Override rules and district default rates are ministry-only. Waste and residue rates and stumpage rates are also visible to forest-industry users.

Screens

Menu item	Who	Use it to
Override Rates	Ministry	Find override rules by timber mark, rule type, field deck, scale or processed dates, or status.
District Default Rates	Ministry	Find default rates by district, appraisal method and effective dates.
Waste & Residue Rates	All	Find waste/residue rates by timber mark, cut block and scale dates.
Compute Waste & Residue Average Rate	All	Compute an average rate for a mark over a period, by species and grade.
Search for Stumpage Rate	All	Look up the stumpage rate that applies.



Search for Override Rules (the menu item is Override Rates)

Common tasks

Add an override rate rule

1. **Rating › Override Rates**, then add a rate rule. The screen is **Add Override Rate Rule**.
2. Enter the timber mark (or field scale deck ID), the scale and/or process date ranges it applies to, and a reason.
3. Save, then add rate lines (species, product, grade, rate) with **Save and Add More Rate Details**.
4. Select **Activate Rule** when it is complete. A rule can later be switched off with **De-activate Rule**.

To bill a mark (or field deck) at the rates of a different date instead, add an **Override Date Rule** from the same screen.

Update a district default rate

Rate Administrator role.

1. **Rating › District Default Rates** and search.
2. Select a rate in the results to open **Update Default Rate**, change it and save.

Without the Rate Administrator role the results are read-only: the rows are not links.

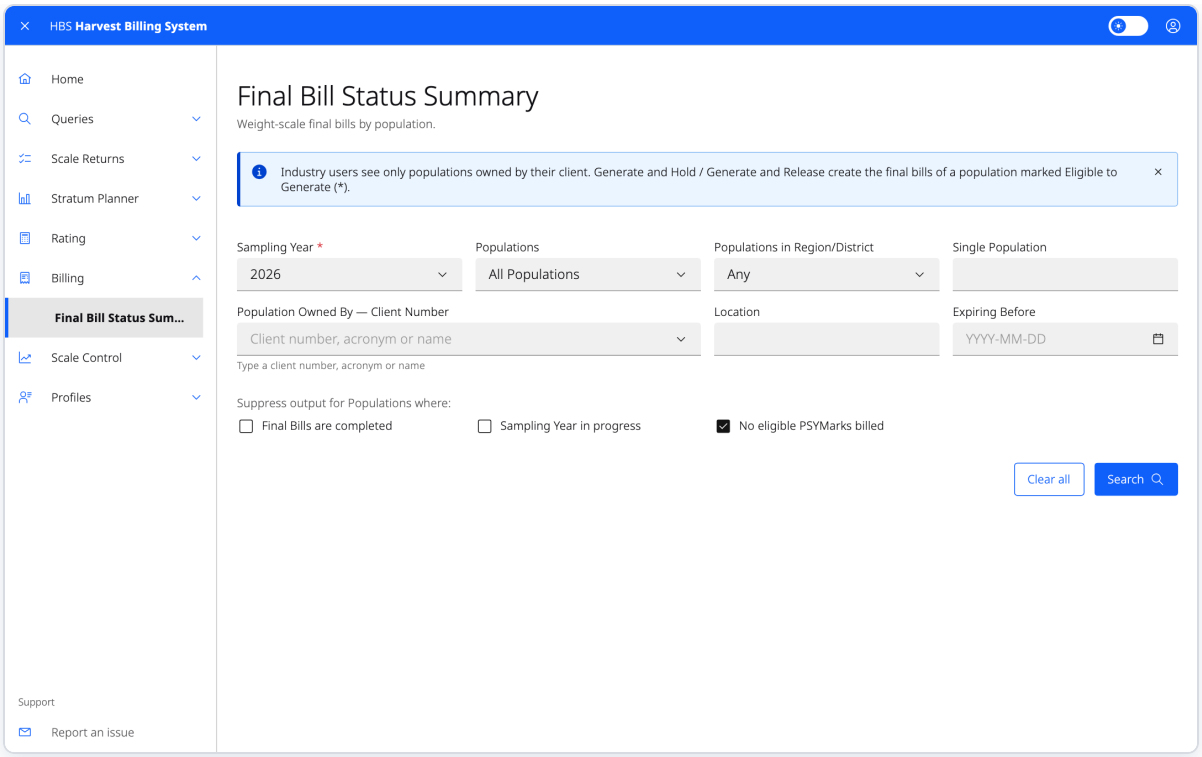
Changing rates needs the Rate Administrator role. Changing waste and residue rates needs the Waste/Residue Rate Administrator role.

6. Billing

Final bills for weight-scale populations, the tenures that receive them, field-scaled decks, and forcing summarization dates. Status screens are visible to ministry and forest-industry users. Everything else needs a billing role.

Screens

Menu item	Who	Use it to
Final Bill Status Summary	All	See final-bill progress by population and sampling year. Drill into one population for its strata.
Search For Unissued Final Bills	Billing Administrator, Super Manager	List final bills that are Ready, Held or in Error. Tick rows and use **Hold Selected** or **Release Selected**.
Non-Renewable Tenures That Receive Final Bills	Billing Administrator, Super Manager	Maintain the list of tenures that get final bills (add, update, delete).
Non-Renewable Tenures Not Receiving Final Bills	Billing Administrator, Super Manager	See tenures whose ratios are frozen and get no final bill.
Field Scaled Decks	Billing Administrator, Scaling Administrator, Super Manager	Find returns by timber mark or field scale deck ID and open the field scale overview.
Force Piece Scale Tally Summarization	Super Manager	Force the next piece-scale summarization date on mark holder profiles.
Force Weigh Slip Summarization	Super Manager	Force the next weight-slip summarization date on mark holder profiles.
Force Ratio Computation	Super Manager	Force the next ratio computation date on population profiles.



Final Bill Status Summary

Common tasks

Hold or release final bills before they issue

1. **Billing › Search For Unissued Final Bills**.
2. Filter by mark, population, sampling year, stratum or status, and select **Search**.
3. Tick the bills, then select **Hold Selected** or **Release Selected**. The result is shown for each bill.

Force a summarization

1. **Billing › Force Piece Scale Tally Summarization** (or **Force Weigh Slip Summarization**).
2. Narrow the profiles by frequency, client and location, and give the **Force date**.
3. Search to see the profiles affected, then apply it to the listed profiles or to all matching profiles.

7. Scale Control

Monitor scaling for problems: late submissions, anomalies found overnight, changes made to returns, timber transport, Load Description Slip (LDS) registry use, and the software sites submit with.

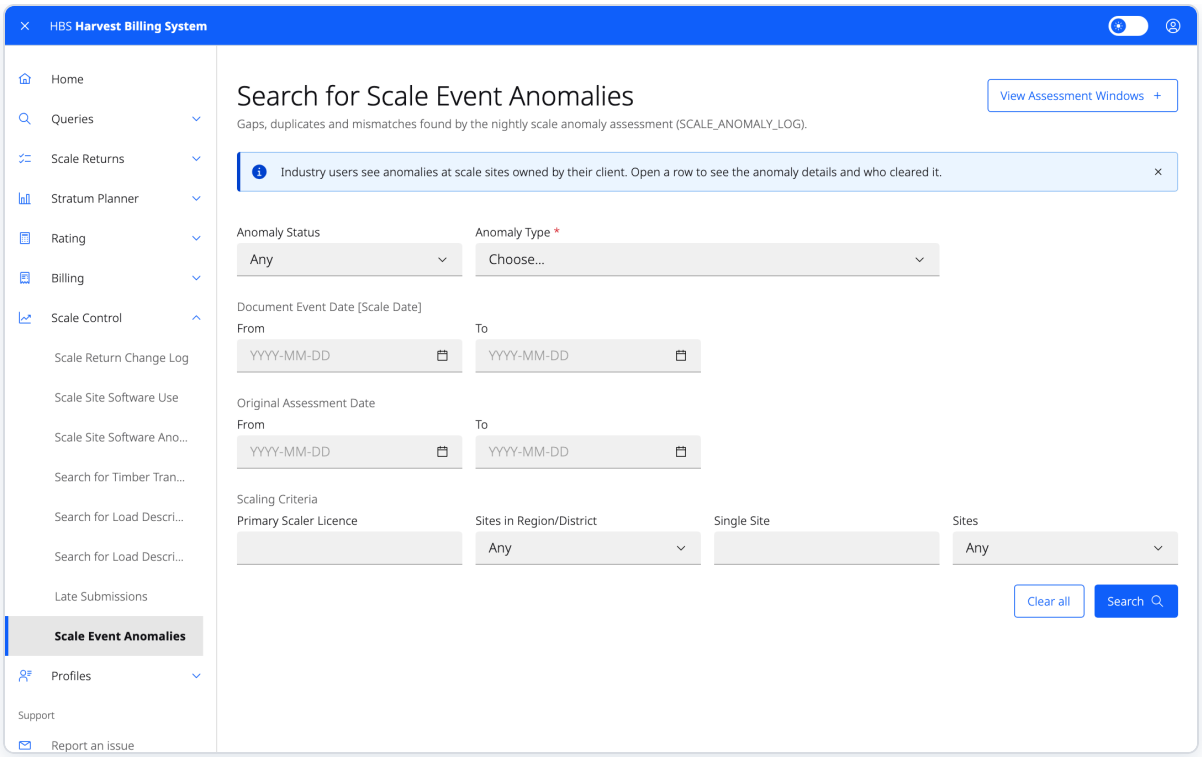
Screens

Menu item	Who	Use it to
Late Submissions	All	Find detail returns received more than a given number of days after their scale date.
Scale Event Anomalies	All	Find gaps, duplicates and mismatches found by the nightly anomaly check. Print a report for each anomaly type.
Scale Site Software Anomalies	All	Find returns submitted with software that is not on file, or not valid on the scale date.
Scale Site Software Use	All, plus software vendors	See which software product, version and revision each scale site submitted with.
Scale Return Change Log	Ministry	Find field-level changes made to returns, by format, date range and user.
Search for Timber Transport Events	Ministry	Find departures, arrivals and intra-site movements by mark, cut block, site, dates, load or weigh slip number.
Search for Load Description Slip Registry Entries	Ministry	Find the LDS number ranges registered to a mark and cut block.
Search for Load Description Slip Registry Violations	Ministry	Find loads that used LDS numbers outside the registered ranges.

Common tasks

Clear a scale anomaly

1. **Scale Control › Scale Event Anomalies**.
2. Filter by status, type, dates, scaler or site, and select **Search**.
3. Open the anomaly and select **Clear** once it is explained.



Scale Event Anomalies criteria

Clearing anomalies needs the Scaling Administrator role.

Register LDS numbers for a cut block

1. **Scale Control › Search for Load Description Slip Registry Entries**.
2. Add an entry with the timber mark, cut block, and starting and ending numbers.

Entries can be updated or deleted later from their detail page. This needs the Scaling Administrator role.

See the change history of one return

From a return, open its change log. The **Scale Return Change Log** shows every changed field for that document and version.

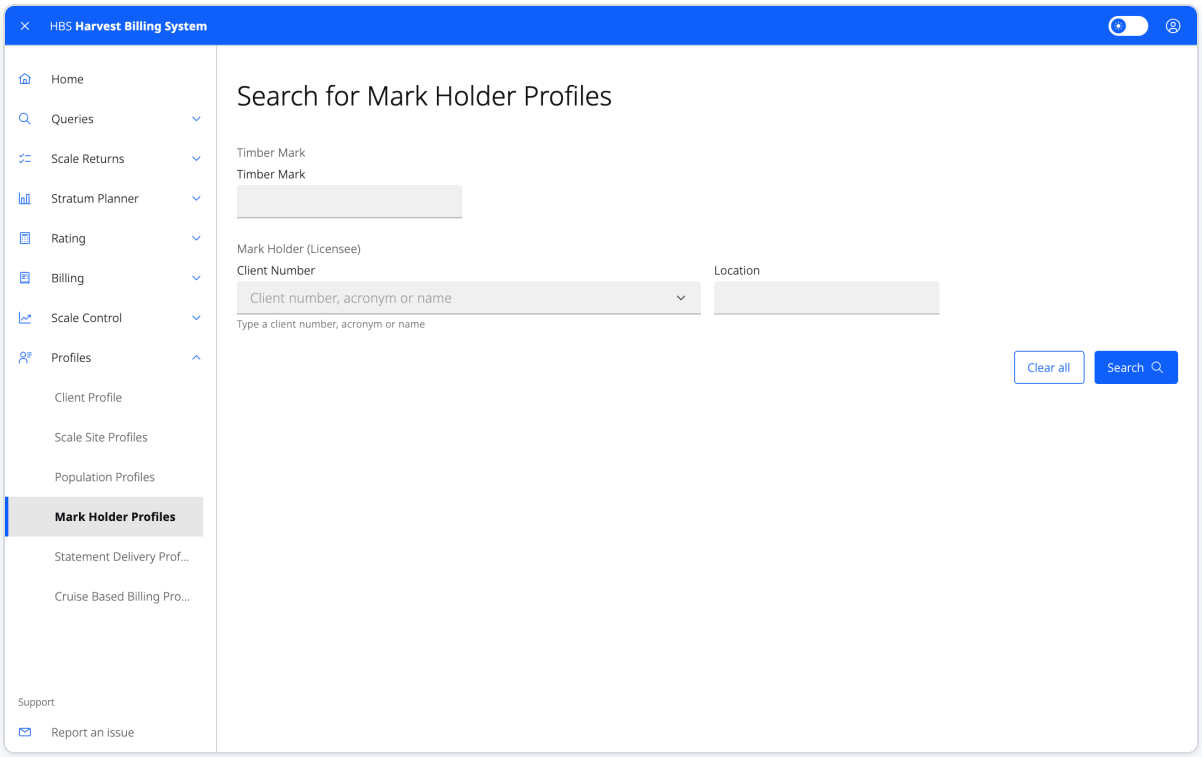
8. Profiles

Profiles hold the settings HBS uses for each client, site, population, mark, scaler and statement delivery. Anyone with an HBS role can view profiles for their data. Changes need the role shown below.

Screens

Menu item	Change role	Holds
Client Profile	— (view only)	Client details by client number and location
Scale Site Profiles	Scaling Administrator	Submission type, return type and effective dates for each scale site
Population Profiles	Sample Plan Administrator	Sampling year, frequency and ratio computation period for each population
Mark Holder Profiles	Billing Administrator	Return type, summarization frequency and next scheduled summarization for each timber mark
Statement Delivery Profiles	Billing Administrator	How statements are delivered to a client location
Cruise Based Billing Profiles	Billing Administrator	m^3/ha by species and billing code for cruise-based marks
Scaler Profile	Scaling Administrator, Industry Scaler	A scaler's authentication keys
Scalers with Expiring Authentication Keys	Scaling Administrator	Scalers whose authentication keys expire before a date
Request Authentication Key	Scaling Administrator, Industry Scaler	Issue a new authentication key for a scaler

Each profile search leads to a detail page with **Update** and **Delete**, and an **Add** form, for users with the change role.



Search for Mark Holder Profiles

Common tasks

Issue a scaler authentication key

1. **Profiles › Request Authentication Key**.
2. Enter the scaler licence, the requested key (7 to 9 upper-case letters or digits; HBS adds a check digit), and the scale date it is active from.
3. Save. The confirmation shows the full key and its active dates.

Record the key and give it to the scaler straight away. It is not shown again.

Change how a client receives statements

1. **Profiles › Statement Delivery Profiles**, search by client number and location.
2. Open the profile and select **Update**, or add a new profile with a new effective date.
3. Choose the **Document Delivery Method** and save.

9. Administration

Who gets access is managed in FAM, not HBS

Requesting access, approving it and granting roles all happen in **FAM (Forest Access Management)**. HBS has no registration or approval screens. Contact your organization's FAM administrator, or the ministry for ministry roles.

User Data Domains

User Administrator roles (ministry, industry or other industry).

A user's **data domains** narrow where their roles apply and set their default search criteria. There are three kinds:

- **Associated Districts**
- **Associated Sites** (scale sites)
- **Associated Locations** (client locations)

For example, the "Marks in Associated Districts" search option uses a user's Associated Districts.

1. **Administration › User Data Domains**.
2. Search by user ID (`IDIR\NAME` or `BCEID\NAME`), name, email, user type, status, client or organization unit.
3. Open the user. Use **Add Associated District**, **Add Associated Site** or **Add Associated Location**, or **Remove** an existing one.

Changes take effect immediately. Industry administrators can only change users in their own organization.

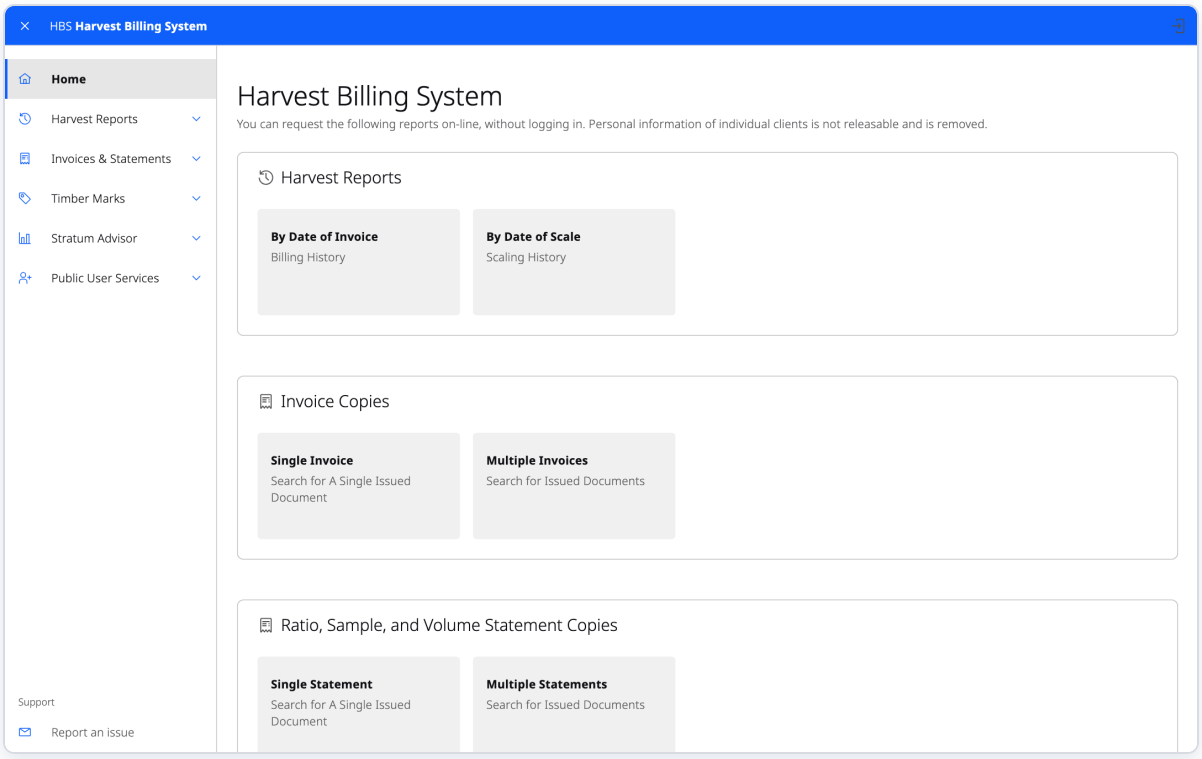
Alert and Processing Parameters

Production Control role.

Administration › Harvest Billing System Alert and Processing Parameters holds system-wide settings used by the overnight processing, and the alert message shown on the home page.

10. Public area

Some HBS information is public. Anyone can open the public area without logging in. It is read-only, and names and addresses of individual clients are shown as "Not Releasable".



The public home page

What is there

Menu	Contents
Harvest Reports	Public harvest and billing reports
Invoices & Statements	Copies of issued invoices and statements, and **Invoice Information**
Timber Marks	Timber mark information
Stratum Advisor	Which stratum a load belongs to
Public User Services	**How to get access**

Searches in the public area return a limited number of rows. If you send a lot of requests in a short time you are asked to wait before trying again.

How to get access

Public User Services › How to get access explains how to request an HBS role through FAM. Once you hold a role, log in with IDIR or Business BCeID (see Getting started).

11. Who can do what

Your roles decide which areas, screens and buttons you see. Roles stack: you hold one **base role** that lets you view, plus any number of roles that let you change things. Industry roles are granted per organization.

Base roles (viewing)

Role	For	Can view
Ministry User	Ministry staff	Every area, including ministry-only screens
Industry User	Forest-industry clients	Queries, Scale Returns, Stratum Planner, Rating, Billing, Scale Control and Profiles, for their own organization
Other Industry User	Submission agents, software vendors	Scale Returns, for their own organization

Ministry roles

Role	Lets you
Ministry User Administrator	Maintain user data domains
Ministry User Manager	Maintain user data domains; generate final bills
Help Desk	View only (same as Ministry User)
Detail Data Entry	Enter and change detail returns; submit XML files; batch slips
Ministry Check Scaler	Enter and change detail returns; submit XML files
Summary Data Control	Enter and change summary returns, including weight and sample returns; batch slips
Summary Data Correction	Summary Data Control, plus cancel and replace invoiced summary returns
Scaling Administrator	Scale site profiles, scaler profiles and keys, anomalies, LDS registry, field-scaled decks; enter and change returns; submit XML files
Sample Plan Administrator	Change sampling plans, strata, default ratios and population profiles
Rate Administrator	Change override rules and rates, and district default rates

Role	Lets you
Waste/Residue Rate Administrator	Change waste and residue rates
Billing Administrator	Final bills, mark holder, delivery and cruise-based billing profiles, field-scaled decks, rate correction requests, approving detail return changes, cancel and replace summary returns
Invoice Correction Approver	Approve or reject rate corrections and detail return changes
Super Manager	Final bills, field-scaled decks, forcing summarization and ratio computation
Production Control	Processing parameters, anomaly assessment windows, batch slips

Industry roles (per organization)

Role	Lets you
Industry User Administrator	Maintain data domains for your organization's users
Industry Site Administrator	Enter and change returns; submit XML files; work anomalies
Industry Scaler	Industry Site Administrator, plus scaler profiles and authentication keys
Industry Cruise Based Administrator	Enter summary returns; hold or discard cruise-based (area) returns for your marks
Industry Sample Plan Administrator	Change your organization's sampling plans
Industry Document Receiver	Search statement transmissions across all your associated locations

Other industry roles (per organization)

Role	Lets you
Other Industry Administrator	Maintain data domains for your organization's users
Data Submission Agent	Enter summary returns; submit XML files
Software Vendor	Submit XML files; view scale site software use

Getting a role

Roles are granted in FAM. See How to get access.